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Maths puzzles for early finishers

Early Finisher Puzzles

Primary 4

Semester 2

Terms 3 and 4

20 single-page puzzles
Almost every puzzle checks itself
One star and two star pages
Teacher answer key included

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Notes

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Teacher notes (DRAFT)

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What this is

Twenty single-page maths puzzles for Primary 4 pupils who finish their work early. This is Semester 2 of two booklets (Terms 3 and 4). Each page stands alone, so you can hand out one page or keep a tray of pages. The pupil needs no help to start.

Which terms

The pages are grouped by the order in which Primary 4 topics are typically taught: this booklet follows Terms 3 and 4, the other booklet follows Semester 1 (Terms 1 and 2). Schools vary, so check your scheme of work: use a page whenever its topic has been taught, from either booklet.

Stars

One star pages practise a topic as it is usually taught (10 pages). Two star pages use the same topics with two steps or two clues to combine (10 pages).

How the pages check themselves

The boxed strip at the foot of each page tells the pupil how to check. The check shows that something is wrong. It does not give the answer, and it asks the pupil to see whether the answer makes sense. Every answer box and every letter box must be filled: a box left blank gives no letter, and the check cannot see it.

- **Code word.** The answers give letters that spell a word. The strip gives no hint of the word. Each word can be spelt from its letters in one way only, so answers in the wrong boxes never make another word, and one or two wrong answers very rarely do. A box left empty gives no letter and is not seen by the check.
- **Colour by code.** Each answer is found in a key of five numbers and the part is coloured with that crayon. The pupil counts the parts of each colour and compares with the box on the page; matching parts must share a colour.
- **Letters in an order, a grid or a choice.** Each number, card, picture or choice carries a letter; the letters, read in the order asked, must spell a word. Where one item is left out, its letter is a decoy that is not part of the word.
- **Totals.** Every row and every line must add up to the total printed on the page (the magic square, the table with totals).

Marking is not needed. To spot-check, look only at the check strip.

How the checks were tested

A script tried every single wrong answer and every wrong arrangement on every page. Each check rejected at least 95% of them. A wrong answer that spells any of about 241 000 English words counts as not rejected. Two wrong answers at once were not all tested.

Teacher notes: using the pages (DRAFT)

Using the pages

- **Time.** Most pages take 5 to 15 minutes; the colour-by-code pages (S2-20) take longer because pupils colour a picture. Pupils need their own crayons (five colours: yellow, red, blue, green, orange). For a pencil-only copy the pupil writes Y, R, B, G or O in each part; the tally and the matching parts are checked the same way. Light crayons work best: a dark crayon hides the number in the part on a photocopy.
- **If the check fails.** The pupil goes back, looks for the slip, and asks a friend or you if still stuck.
- **Problem solving.** Some pages (S2-06, S2-10, S2-19) practise the kinds of question that appear in school tests, such as stories with fractions, decimals, perimeter and area and several steps, rather than one numbered syllabus outcome. The key tags them problem solving.
- **Stars.** One star: one skill, as usually taught. Two stars: the same topics with two steps or two clues to combine.
- **Drawings.** Pictures of figures, solids, nets, graphs and protractors are original drawings. Rectilinear figures are drawn to a scale, but pupils are never asked to measure the page. A protractor picture is for reading only. Pupils use their own protractor and ruler only if a page says so.

Photocopying

All pages are black and white with solid lines, so they copy cleanly. Use normal toner, not a light setting, so that the thin dashed lines on the pie charts and graphs stay visible. Each page is one side only. Pupils write on the page, and the answer boxes are large. Use A4 and print at 100% (actual size).

Pictures are not actual size.

Contents: Semester 2

Page	Code	Puzzle	Tier
S2-01	P4-21	Decimal Place Value	1 star
S2-02	P4-22	Order the Decimals	1 star
S2-03	P4-23	Decimal Match	1 star
S2-04	P4-24	Rounding Decimals	1 star
S2-05	P4-25	Magic Decimals	2 stars
S2-06	P4-26	Decimal Shares	2 stars
S2-07	P4-27	Missing Sides	1 star
S2-08	P4-28	L-Shapes	1 star
S2-09	P4-29	Match the Figures	2 stars
S2-10	P4-30	Joined Shapes	2 stars
S2-11	P4-31	Shape Facts	1 star
S2-12	P4-32	Complete the Corner	2 stars
S2-13	P4-33	Mirror Lines	1 star
S2-14	P4-34	Complete the Figure	2 stars
S2-15	P4-35	Name the Solid	1 star
S2-16	P4-36	Which Net?	2 stars
S2-17	P4-37	Complete the Table	2 stars
S2-18	P4-38	Line Graph Detective	1 star
S2-19	P4-39	Pie Chart	2 stars
S2-20	P4-40	Colour the Ferry	2 stars

Pages are independent. The footer code shows the page in this booklet and, in brackets, its number in the full set of 40 (P4-01 to P4-40).

What the booklet covers

Fraction of a Set 2.1 fraction as part of a set **S2-19**

Decimals up to 3 decimal places 1.1 notation, representations and place values (tenths, hundredths, thousandths) **S2-01**

Decimals up to 3 decimal places 1.2 comparing and ordering decimals **S2-02, S2-20**

Decimals up to 3 decimal places 1.3 expressing decimals as fractions **S2-03**

Decimals up to 3 decimal places 1.4 expressing fractions as decimals when the denominator is a factor of 10 or 100 **S2-03, S2-20**

Decimals up to 3 decimal places 1.5 rounding decimals to the nearest whole number, 1 decimal place, 2 decimal places **S2-04, S2-20**

Decimals: Addition and Subtraction 2.1 adding and subtracting decimals (up to 2 decimal places) **S2-05, S2-20**

Decimals: Multiplication and Division 3.1 multiplying and dividing decimals (up to 2 decimal places) by a 1-digit whole number **S2-06, S2-20**

Decimals: Multiplication and Division 3.2 dividing a whole number by a whole number with quotient as a decimal **S2-06, S2-20**

Decimals: Multiplication and Division 3.3 rounding answers to a specified degree of accuracy **S2-06**

Area and Perimeter 1.1 finding one dimension of a rectangle given the other dimension and its area/perimeter **S2-07, S2-10**

Area and Perimeter 1.2 finding the length of one side of a square given its area/perimeter **S2-07, S2-10**

Area and Perimeter 1.3 finding the area and perimeter of composite figures made up of rectangles and squares **S2-08, S2-09, S2-10**

Rectangle and Square 2.1 properties of rectangle and square, excluding diagonal properties **S2-11, S2-12**

Rectangle and Square 2.2 drawing rectangles and squares (partly: the pupil only chooses the corner) **S2-12**

Line Symmetry 3.1 identifying symmetric figures **S2-13, S2-14**

Line Symmetry 3.2 determining whether a straight line is a line of symmetry of a symmetric figure **S2-13**

Line Symmetry 3.3 completing a symmetric figure with respect to a given line of symmetry on square grid **S2-14**

Nets 4.1 identifying 2D representations of cube, cuboid, cone, cylinder, prism, pyramid **S2-15**

Nets 4.3 identifying the nets of 3D solids (cube, cuboid, prism, pyramid) **S2-16**

Nets 4.4 identifying the solid which can be formed by a given net **S2-16**

Tables, Line Graphs and Pie Charts 1.1 completing a table from given data **S2-17**

Tables, Line Graphs and Pie Charts 1.2 reading and interpreting data from tables/line graphs/pie charts **S2-17, S2-18, S2-19**

Practised in the other booklet: Numbers up to 100 000 1.1, 1.2, 1.3, 1.4, 1.5, 1.6; Factors and Multiples 2.1, 2.2, 2.3, 2.4, 2.5; Four Operations 3.1, 3.2; Mixed Numbers and Improper Fractions 1.1; Fractions: Addition and Subtraction 3.1; Angles 1.1, 1.2.

No page: drawing an angle of a given size (Angles 1.3) and drawing a solid (Nets 4.2). A printed page cannot check a drawing, so these are left to your lessons.